STEALTH (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Stealth is a **Dexterity** skill. It is used to **hide** from enemies, **slip past** guards, and **leave unseen and unheard**. It is used with the **Hide** action, which grants the **Invisible** condition while you stay hidden.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. To hide, use the **Hide** action: a **Dexterity (Stealth) DC 15** check.
2. You must be **Heavily Obscured** or behind **Three-Quarters Cover** or **Total Cover**, and **out of an enemy's line of sight**.
3. Success: you are **Invisible** while you stay hidden. Note the **result**: it is the **DC** to locate you.
4. An enemy searches with the **Search** action: a **Wisdom (Perception)** check against that DC.
5. The condition ends if you make a **sound**, are **found**, **attack**, or cast a **Verbal** spell.

⚠ Using another ability:

- The ability of a check is decided **by the situation**: the DM may pair Stealth with **Constitution** (staying motionless for hours) or **Charisma** (blending into a crowd). Table rule
- The **Proficiency Bonus** applies when the skill **fits** and you are proficient.
- See the **Use cases** page.

⚠ Change from 2014

Hiding is an **action** (Hide) with a **fixed DC of 15**, limited to certain places, and it grants the **Invisible** condition. The **check's result** becomes the DC to locate you, instead of a comparison with passive Perception.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

You can't hide **in the open**, which frustrates some tables. The rules also don't say how to **sneak** outside combat. Fix: the **DM announces** the DC and what counts as cover **before** the roll.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

Describe the **held breath**, the heart beating too loud, the torch passing a yard from the hiding spot.

STEALTH (5E, 2024 RULES) – HOW TO PLAY

Step 1 – Decide whether a roll is needed:

A roll happens only if someone can **spot** your character and the outcome is **uncertain**. With no observer, stealth is automatic.

Step 2 – Check the conditions:

Your character is **Heavily Obscured** or behind **Three-Quarters Cover** or **Total Cover**, and **out of an enemy's line of sight**. If they see a creature, they know whether it sees them.

Step 3 – Take the Hide action:

A **Dexterity (Stealth) DC 15** check. The Rogue can use Hide as a **Bonus Action** (Cunning Action). On a success, you are **Invisible**; note the result.

Example: Brann (Dexterity +3, Proficiency +2) crouches behind a barrel (Three-Quarters Cover). He rolls 11 + 3 + 2 = 16: he is Invisible, locating DC 16.

Step 4 – Being searched for:

An enemy takes the **Search** action: a **Wisdom (Perception)** check. It must **meet or beat** the Hide result.

Next: the guard (Wisdom +2) rolls 12 + 2 = 14 against 16: he doesn't find Brann.

Step 5 – The Invisible condition ends:

- You make a **sound louder than a whisper**.
- An **enemy finds you**.
- You make an **attack roll** (the attack still gets Advantage).
- You cast a spell with a **Verbal component**.

Step 6 – Sneak (outside Hide):

To slip past guards, the DM asks for a **Dexterity (Stealth)** check if the outcome is uncertain. DC: scale **5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30**.

🕶 The Invisible condition at a glance

- **Concealed:** you are not affected by effects that require seeing their target, unless the effect's creator can see you. Your gear is concealed with you.
- **Attacks:** attack rolls against you have **Disadvantage**; your attack rolls have **Advantage**. Against a creature that can still see you, you don't get this benefit.
- **Initiative: Advantage** on the Initiative roll.
- **End:** see step 5. With Hide, the condition lasts while you stay hidden.

STEALTH (5E, 2024 RULES) – TABLES

Stealth uses in the 2024 rules:

Situation	Check and DC
Hide (Hide action) while Heavily Obscured or behind Three-Quarters/Total Cover, out of line of sight	Dexterity (Stealth) **DC 15**: Invisible condition
Be located by an enemy (Search action)	Wisdom (Perception) ≥ **the Hide result**
Wear armor whose Stealth column says Disadvantage	**Disadvantage** on Dexterity (Stealth) checks
Rogue level 2 (Cunning Action)	Hide as a **Bonus Action**

When one use case leads to another:

First check	Consequence	Next use case
Successful Hide	You are Invisible	**Advantage** on attacks, **Disadvantage** against you (Invisible sheet)
Hide before combat	Enemies unaware	**Surprise**: Disadvantage on Initiative (Surprise sheet)
Invisible on the Initiative roll	Advantage	You act **before** your enemies (Initiative sheet)
Enemy's successful Search	You are located	Invisible ends: **normal** combat
Attack from hiding	The Invisible condition ends	The enemy **locates** you and can retaliate

Chain example: Brann (Invisible) attacks the archer guard with Advantage, then the condition ends. The guard locates him and retaliates.

STEALTH (5E, 2024 RULES) – USE CASES

Ability + skill combinations: Table rule

*The DM decides the ability by the situation and applies proficiency if it fits. These combinations are **exceptions announced before the roll**.*

Combination	Use in play
Constitution (Stealth)	Stay motionless in a painful position for hours without moving an eyelash.
Charisma (Stealth)	Practice "social stealth" (pass as a waiter to infiltrate a party).
Intelligence (Stealth)	Plan a stealthy route by spotting blind spots and patrol rounds.
Wisdom (Stealth)	Sense you are being watched and freeze at the right moment.
Strength (Stealth)	Move a heavy chest or coffin without making a sound.

Neighboring skills:

Skill	Use in play
Dexterity (Sleight of Hand)	Conceal a small object on yourself or slip it away unseen.
Charisma (Deception)	Lie to justify your presence if you are spotted.

How to choose: Table rule

1. What does the task demand: **power, agility, endurance, mind, presence**? That gives the ability.
2. Which skill describes the **know-how**? Apply proficiency if it fits.
3. The DM **announces** the combination and the DC before the roll.

*Example: Mira (Constitution +2, Stealth proficiency +2) stays motionless 3 hours in a niche, DC 15. She rolls $10 + 2 + 2 = 14$: failure, she cracks and moves. See also the **Athletics** sheet.*

STEALTH (5E, 2024 RULES) – Q&A AND DEBATE

Common table questions.

Can you hide in the open?

No: the Hide action requires **Heavily Obscured** or **Three-Quarters/Total Cover**, and being **out of an enemy's line of sight**.

Stealth or passive Perception?

The **Hide result** becomes the DC to locate you with **Wisdom (Perception)** via the Search action. For an enemy who isn't searching, the DM may compare to its **passive Perception** (table rule).

How long do I stay Invisible?

While you stay hidden: until **a sound louder than a whisper**, **being found**, **an attack roll**, or **a Verbal spell**.

Does an attack from hiding benefit from the condition?

Yes: the condition ends **right after** the attack roll, so it gets Advantage.

Does a spell ruin stealth?

Only if it has a **Verbal component**. A spell without one doesn't end it.

Can a group hide together?

Each character uses their **own Hide action** and makes their own check.

Does armor hinder?

Yes: if the armor table's **Stealth** column says Disadvantage, you have Disadvantage.

Is a 20 an automatic success?

No: on an ability check, a **20** or a **1** has no special effect.

Which features help?

The Rogue (Cunning Action, Bonus Action), **Expertise**, and the Rogue treating a 9 or lower as a 10.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

20 and 1 on a check

On an ability check, a 20 or a 1 has no special effect: no Critical Hit, no automatic failure.

Hidden, invisible, found

A hidden creature has the Invisible condition, which ends when a creature finds it. Blindsight and Truesight reveal it.

Hiding again

After attacking, you need the Hide action to hide again, unless you have a special ability.

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